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Harvard burnishes image amid attacks

Under fire from Trump, school takes to heart PR lesson to never waste a crisis

By Aidan Ryan
and Brooke Hauser
GLOBE STAFF

Two inscriptions adorn Harvard Yard's Dexter Gate: "Enter to grow in wisdom" on the way in, and "Depart to serve better thy country and thy kind" on the way out.

The gate speaks to the school's mission of public service since its founding nearly 400 years ago, a mission that Harvard has repeatedly tried to convey to the public.

But just how far has that message

traveled?

Since March, Harvard has become a top target in the Trump administration's efforts to overhaul higher education. President Trump portrays the university as a left-wing echo chamber that does little to enrich the lives of those outside its gates. The university, in response, has activated an all-out media blitz to burnish its image in the eyes of the American public.

Harvard president Alan Garber, in recent months, has taken to tele-

vision stations, newspapers, and radio to warn about the federal government's encroachment on academic and institutional freedom. Meanwhile, the Ivy League school has stepped up its efforts — on social

► **Rubio pushes for new investigation of Harvard. A2.**

media and in mainstream outlets — to explain how its army of scientific researchers is working on everything from developing treatments for cancer to preventing life-threatening food allergies. That work, the university points out, is now at grave risk because of billions in federal

funding cuts.

Winston Churchill is sometimes credited "as saying that you never want to 'let a good crisis go to waste,'" said Bradley Akubuiro, a partner at Washington-based communications firm Bully Pulpit International who focuses on corporate crisis management.

Harvard is seizing "an opportunity to educate people about not only what they do, but what they don't do" and "what they stand for," he added.

It's a change in approach for Harvard, which for years has largely let its elite brand speak for itself, and

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In LA, city's calm belies talk of crisis

For visitors, residents, life goes on as usual despite White House assertions

By Reis Thebault
WASHINGTON POST

LOS ANGELES — From the Griffith Observatory, a landmark perched on a hilltop 1,000 feet above sea level, Joe and Jolene McGuire had a prime view of this vast city, and they couldn't see what their friends and family back home in Nebraska were so worried about.

For days — as social media feeds and cable news replayed images of burning cars and smashed windows, as President Trump claimed a violent insurrection was underway — the couple fretted about whether they should cancel their anniversary trip out West.

Yet the Los Angeles they saw after arriving Tuesday morning was serene: sunny skies, peaceful streets, no hint of civil unrest or the federal government's aggressive, militarized response.

"If you're not here, you think LA's burning to the ground," Joe McGuire said. "But you come out here, you look around and you just say, 'My God, this is where I want to be.'"

Despite Trump's assertions that Los Angeles was beset by widespread lawlessness (Story, A7), a chaos he insisted could be quelled only by thousands of National Guard troops and Marines, the

LOS ANGELES, Page A7

Eating out is an ever more costly choice

Restaurants, guests seek ways to cope as prices rise

By Camilo Fonseca
GLOBE STAFF

It's not just you — your restaurant bill is looking heavier than usual.

Grocery costs in the Boston area have edged slightly downward from where they were this time last year, according to the most recent Consumer Price Index data. But you probably wouldn't know it if you've gone out to eat recently.

Food away from home, a category that includes restaurants, bars, and other public establishments, was up 6 percent year-over-year in Greater Boston as of March, the most recent price data available. That's still below the recent peak of nearly 10 percent, which it reached in September 2022. But it's a metric that has been trending upward since last fall — a worrying sign for diners and eateries alike.

Step into one restaurant in the North End, for

DINING OUT, Page A5



JESSICA RINALDI/GLOBE STAFF

Marcelo Gomes da Silva with his brother Miguel, 7, at the family's Milford home. Gomes said he plans to apply for asylum.

Released but still unsettled

After ICE detention, Milford teen grapples with uncertain future

By Marcela Rodrigues
GLOBE STAFF

MILFORD — While sitting on the cold, concrete floor of a detention cell, 18-year-old Marcelo Gomes da Silva thought about life outside that had been so abruptly closed off to him.

The faces of his parents, siblings, and girlfriend persistently played across his mind, competing with the fear of being deported to a country he hasn't seen since the age of 6.

Through all that tumult, the Brazilian native, who made national headlines with his arrest by ICE on May 31, clung to his faith, continually whispering prayers to be released and returned to his community in Milford, where he grew up attending public schools and plays varsity volleyball.

"Use me for your glory," the teen prayed over and over again for the five nights he spent in detention at a federal facility in Burlington. "Use me as a light."

Gomes was able to return to that life when an immigration judge on Thursday said he should be released on bond. He was excited to get back to Milford High School the next day to take final exams and wrap up his junior year.

But it would not be so easy to pick up where he left off, after being handcuffed at the wrists, ankles, and waist and spending nearly a week without sunlight or a shower. He still faces deportation, awaiting a removal proceeding that has not yet been scheduled. He said he plans to apply for asylum, a process that can last several years.

For the first few days back home, Gomes barely left the house, his parents warning

him to be cautious and to watch out for potential threats. Not everyone supported his release, they said.

There have been taunts on social media, people saying he deserved to be detained and thrown out of the country.

"When it gets quiet, I don't really like thinking about a bunch of things and all that. So I have people over to get my mind to calm down," Gomes said.

Milford police have checked in on the family more than a dozen times in the past week, according to police logs, and escorted him to destinations outside his home.

"Protecting Marcelo and our undocumented population is paramount to us," said Milford police Chief Robert Tusino. "Regardless of your status, you're going to get our protection. And if you commit a crime, you

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Warmth of the sun

Thursday: Breezy, warm.
High: 84-89. Low: 60-65.

Friday: Cooler, pleasant.
High: 72-77. Low: 57-62.

Sunrise: 5:07 Sunset: 8:21

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JULIA DEMAREE NIKHINSON

PARADE PREPARATIONS — An Army soldier walked by a Bradley fighting vehicle staged in West Potomac Park on Wednesday ahead of Saturday's parade commemorating the Army's 250th anniversary and coinciding with President Trump's 79th birthday. **A7.**

A motion to dissolve the Israeli Parliament failed in the most serious challenge yet to Prime Minister Benjamin Netanyahu's government. **A3.**

New England voters strongly disapprove of Robert F. Kennedy Jr.'s performance

and policies as health secretary, according to a new Globe/Suffolk poll. **B1.**

MassDOT chose Irish firm Applegreen to rebuild and operate 18 highway plazas, including the 11 on the Massachusetts Turnpike. **D1.**

BRIAN WILSON 1942-2025

Visionary leader of the Beach Boys

By Ben Sisario
NEW YORK TIMES

Brian Wilson, who as the leader and chief songwriter of the Beach Boys became rock's poet laureate of surf-and-sun innocence, but also an embodiment of damaged genius through his struggles with mental illness and drugs, has died. He was 82.

His family announced the death but did not say where or when he died, or state a cause. In 2024, after the death of his wife, Melinda Wilson, business representatives for Brian Wilson were granted a conservatorship by a California state judge, after they asserted that he had "a major neurocognitive disorder" and had been diagnosed with dementia.

On mid-1960s hits like "Surfin' U.S.A.," "California Girls," and "Fun, Fun, Fun," the Beach Boys created a musical counterpart to the myth of

Southern California as paradise.

That vision, manifested in Mr. Wilson's crystalline vocal arrangements, helped make the Beach Boys the defining American band of the era. During its clean-cut heyday of 1962 to 1966, the group landed 13 singles in the Billboard Top 10. Three of them went to No. 1: "I Get Around," "Help Me, Rhonda," and "Good Vibrations."

At the same time, Mr. Wilson — who didn't surf — became one of pop's most gifted and idiosyncratic studio auteurs.

"That ear," Bob Dylan once remarked. "I mean, Jesus, he's got to will that to the Smithsonian."

Mr. Wilson's masterpiece was the 1966 album "Pet Sounds." The album was a commercial disappointment upon its release, but the technical sophistication and melancholic



LUCAS JACKSON/REUTERS/FILE/2012

Mr. Wilson was known for his talent and eccentricity.

depth of tracks like "God Only Knows" and "I Just Wasn't Made for These Times" eventually led critics and fellow musicians to honor it as an epochal achievement.

But in following up "Pet Sounds," Mr. Wilson stumbled. Over months of sessions for an album he intended to call

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